independent foreign policy. The level of economic development also determines the state's ability to gear up its military preparedness and improvise its military capabilities, which in turn determines its foreign policy objectives. Economic power has worked as a positive leverage for USA, whereas economic decline has worked as a negative factor in the case of Russia as far as their foreign policy stances are concerned.

4. ***National Interest:*** To the realists, 'national interest' is the key factor in determining a state's behaviour with respect to other states. National interest, whether political, economic or military, changes with the changing needs of time and circumstances either in the domestic front or internationally. But undoubtedly, national interest while formulating the of foreign policy of a state, is of supreme importance.

5. ***National Character and National Morale:*** Though many scholars disregard the importance of **national character** as an important input of foreign policy because of its metaphysical overtones, yet national character finds expression in international relations through the perceptions, reactions and behaviour patterns of decision-makers. As Prof. Jayantanuja Bandyopadhyaya suggests if worship of wealth and power are regarded as chief attributes of America's national character, the foreign policy becomes logically one that is consistent with these attributes. In India the culture and belief system has moulded the outlook and foreign policy perspective of the decision-makers too.

National morale is also an elusive category and consists of a state of mind, which sometimes can be called **patriotism** or **love of country.** Willingness to stand up and even sacrifice one's life for one's country is not only an element of national morale of the troops that fight in the front but also of the civilian population.

6. ***Political Structure:*** The political structure of a state and the nature of the ruling elite to a great extent influence the formulation of foreign policy of a state. A democratic state, with a high degree of political accountability, is both responsive and responsible. Therefore, the foreign policy pursued by such a system would be different from the foreign policies pursued by totalitarian and